



ECON 352X – Macroeconomics for Business
Section: 26055R – Tuesday & Thursday 12:30 to 1:50 pm
Fall 2026

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COURSE DESCRIPTION

Making sound business decisions requires knowing the economic environment in which firms operate. It requires an understanding of key economic indicators, the relationship among economic variables, the mechanics of how the economy works, and the role of economic institutions. The topics we cover in this intermediate course in macroeconomics will help you understand how economies function, both in the national and international contexts. Economics is one of the foundations for other functional areas within business, such as Finance and Marketing, and understanding economic concepts will help you understand the issues involved in these more specialized fields.

We will focus on the fundamental issues of macroeconomics, such as long run growth, productivity, labor markets, wages, inequality, business cycles, inflation, money, interest rates, unemployment, monetary and fiscal policy, short run fluctuations of the economy, saving and investment in the open economy, exchange rate determination, financial crisis, global imbalances in the allocation of capital, and sovereign debt crises. We will use macroeconomic tools to analyze how government policy affects the economy, how various disturbances affect the economy, and how economic news affects interest rates, and asset prices. This course is a mixture of macroeconomic theory and real-world applications. We will develop analytical models that stress the microeconomic underpinnings of aggregate outcome, and we will apply these models to the recent experience of the US and other countries. At the end of this course, in addition to understanding the above issues at a conceptual level, you should be able to critically evaluate macroeconomic arguments in the financial press.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

We will spend a considerable amount of time learning, and understanding macroeconomic theories, since those tools are very important in developing the economic intuition, we need to organize concepts and facts. This will help us to evaluate current real-world developments and arguments in a sensible way.

The primary goal of this course is to enable you to make informed judgments about whether the economic environment in a given country makes it a good place to do business.

At the end of the course, you will be able to:

1. Apply graphical and algebraic tools to analyze various economic models and address questions in economics.
2. Apply the basic demand and supply model to calculate equilibrium wage rates, employment, interest rates and investment in an economy.
3. Use the neoclassical growth model to measure and forecast GDP in different economies.
4. Find sources of macroeconomic data, manipulate them, and understand how they have been behaving historically and how they compare across countries.
5. Understand and critically evaluate the news about the macro economy in the financial press.
6. Be able to evaluate the effects of government policy such as changes in tax rates, or money supply on individuals, firms, and the economy
7. Collaborate with others to judge news about the U.S. and world economy. Demonstrate an ability to gather and disseminate information and communicate it clearly, logically, and persuasively in a professional context.

Alignment with Marshall School of Business Program Learning Goals

The above course learning objectives support The Marshall School of Business Learning Goals as follows:

1. Our graduates will have an understanding of the key business areas and their interplay *to effectively manage different types of modern enterprise. High*
2. Our graduates will have a global mindset *demonstrating an understanding of the interplay of local, regional, and international markets, and economic, social and cultural issues. High*
3. Our graduates will demonstrate critical thinking skills, decision-making, and problem-solving abilities to *strategically navigate complex demands of business environments. High*
4. Our graduates will demonstrate leadership skills, *aspiring to be informed, sensible, future-oriented leaders and innovators. Medium*
5. Our graduates will demonstrate ethical reasoning skills, understand social, civic and professional responsibilities and aspire to add value to society. *Low*
6. Our graduates will be effective communicators in speaking and writing to *facilitate information flow in organizational, social, and intercultural contexts. Medium*

Course Focus on Past, Current, and Future Macro-Finance Issues

We challenge students to use economic data and economic analysis to think critically about how to interpret past and current events. Following the events of financial crisis and recession of 2007-2009, understanding macroeconomics has become more important and exciting. The U.S. economy has gone through major changes. The housing market virtually collapsed, average incomes of many households fell; thousands of Americans lost their jobs, their health insurance, and even their homes; and governments at all levels struggled to cope with falling tax collections colliding with increased demands for public services such as unemployment benefits and health care. We have endured the most severe recession since the Great Depression of the 1930s. The response to these events has called forth a transformation of macroeconomic policy making. The U.S. Treasury bailed out some of the major

financial institutions. The Federal Reserve System expanded its open-market operations to include commercial papers and home mortgages and caused the reserves of the banking system to grow at unprecedented rates, even as it brought the key interest rates to near zero.

Finally, we learn to use economic analysis to predict likely changes in the economy. Having witnessed a period in which Federal Reserve officials, members of Congress, heads of Wall Street firms, and everyone else failed to predict the extent of this financial crisis, the idea that we can predict, and even anticipate the future is rather overly ambitious. In short, certain developments have happened to the economy that many economists had thought impossible, and the fiscal and monetary authorities have responded with nothing short of revolutionary changes in the way they conduct policy. During the course of the semester, we will cover the significant factors that contributed to these myriad problems, and explore how and why these factors, along with other contributing elements, triggered a global upheaval.

We embrace the idea that the economies of countries are interrelated, and the fact that we must take seriously the linkages between the U.S. and other economies. Many questions have been raised about our economic system as well as others' and how they might be reformed. How long will the high inflation last? Are rising prices more likely than falling prices? Who is responsible for this dilemma, anyway? How are we going to deal with the large budget and external deficits? The effect of Tax Cuts & Job Act passed in late 2017 and their impact on our overall welfare and investment. Are rising prices more likely than falling prices? What about the substantial gross public debt that is over \$13 trillion? Who is responsible for these, and how do they affect the business world? How will the higher growth in China, India, and other emerging nations affect U.S businesses? And what about the Myths of Social Security? How will the social security crisis affect everyone? How does being part of a global economic system affect the performance of our economy and the world economy as a whole? How should economic policy be conducted to ensure that the economy will be stable and prosperous? We will try to understand the impact of current tariff and the trade war on the global economy- China and US have the most at stake. Macroeconomics attempts to offer answers to these questions, which are not only of great practical importance for the success of business strategies that crucially depend on the economic environment in which they are implemented, but are constantly debated by politicians, the press, and the public.

We will review the global economic recession outlook during the Covid-19 Pandemic Crisis, where the course of pandemic itself was by far the most important factor. Because this recession was unprecedented in so many ways, forecasting the recovery was difficult-some economies took longer to rebound. It inflicted huge damage on economies around the world. But what will be the long-term impact on the global economy, and what changes could be made as a result. We will cover studies and forecasts that address outlook. This was the deepest global recession in decades, despite the extraordinary steps taken by most governments to counter the downturn with massive fiscal and monetary support. We believe, that over the longer horizon, the deep recessions triggered by the pandemic are expected to leave lasting scars through long-term damage to potential output, particularly through loss of small businesses, productivity growth, lower investment, an erosion of human capital through lost work and schooling, and on the global side, fragmentation of global trade and supply chain and linkages. More than ever, global coordination and cooperation on many levels and measures were required to slow the spread of the pandemic. Major actions were needed not only to achieve public health goals but also alleviate the economic and financial damage enabling a robust global recovery.

COURSE MATERIALS

Required Materials:

Course PowerPoint: PowerPoints for each topic are posted under the Content tab of the Brightspace. Please read the PowerPoints at least once before the class lectures.

Problem Sets: Problem set 1-3

Optional Materials:

There is no required textbook for this course. The lectures are based on multiple sources, including various books, academic papers, and research reports produced by private and public sector entities.

Suggested Textbook: *Macroeconomics, 10th ed., Andrew B. Able, Ben S Bernanke, and Dean Croushore- Addison Wesley, Boston.* (Pearson Prentice-Hall, 2020, ISBN 978-0-13-489644-1).

This is an expensive book, so some students may prefer to look for a used textbook. It is fine to buy the previous editions. Copies of the suggested reference text will be placed on reserve in the library.

Brightspace. All course materials will be posted on Brightspace. In addition, it is my principal means of communicating with you outside class. Therefore, it is important that you can get on Brightspace and know how to download files, and that your e-mail account is functioning.

If you have any questions or need assistance with the Brightspace Course Pages, please contact the Marshall HelpDesk at 213-740-3000 or HelpDesk@marshall.usc.edu.

Prerequisites and/or Recommended Preparation. Although our focus will be on the intuition behind the macroeconomic models and their real-world consequences, the use of mathematics (in particular, algebra and calculus) will be fundamental to analyze and understand such models. For example, you must be able to draw and interpret graphs representing demand and supply, to solve a system of equations, or to compute the derivative of a function. MATH 118 and ECON 351x. are prerequisite for ECON 352x. Therefore, I expect students to have a good understanding of the material covered in those classes.

Course Notes and Lecture slides. PowerPoint slides and other relevant material will be posted on Brightspace (<http://Brightspace.usc.edu>) as pdf documents. You are responsible for timely download of the material. It is your responsibility to regularly access Brightspace (<http://Brightspace.usc.edu>) to receive any additional material and important announcements related to this class.

Homework and Assignments. Practice problem sets will be assigned before each exam that include problems and applications. Some of these are conceptual, some are numerical and mathematical application of the theory, others are analytical and encourage you to go beyond the material in the lecture by addressing new issues that are closely related to the topics. **These Practice Problem sets should not be turned in,** I will cover some of them and provide the answer key at the end. These practice questions are important– students who carefully study the homework obtain better grades on the exams.

Documentary Videos and Podcasts: As the course proceeds you should watch the three-part PBS documentary, *Commanding Heights: The Battle for the World Economy*, about the world economy during the twentieth century. These are, Episode 1: The Battle of Ideas; Episode II: The Agony of Reform; and Episode III: The New Rules of the Game. The series is available for free viewing on the YouTube channel of author Daniel Yergin, on whose book the PBS series is based.
https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLYkO4hiKyrSTQt_kp0sK2_YPnjUgK8Omd

Cases and Articles, and Popular Press Reports: I may assign related cases, applications, current articles and podcasts throughout the course and expect you to carefully read them and come to class prepared for discussion.

In addition, I highly recommend that you regularly read sources of economic and business news. Probably the best source of weekly news is The Economist <http://www.economist.com>. It is a British publication with extensive U.S. and world news. The Wall Street Journal is of course a prime source of information. The New York Times has broad coverage and good analysis: <http://www.nytimes.com>. The Financial Times of London is an excellent daily newspaper with a clear international flavor: <http://www.ft.com>. Journal and discussion articles may be assigned during the semester, which will be announced on Brightspace, or during class time. The articles provide an applied perspective to the concepts covered in the lectures.

Class Participation. Class participation is an important ingredient of learning. Being active in the class is probably the most efficient way to absorb the material in the long run. Class **participation grades** will be allocated based on quality of participation. Prompt daily attendance is required. (If an absence is required, please e-mail me in advance.) *"Cold calls" will be used extensively.* Excellent participation involves enhancing the class experience for your classmates by answering questions that I ask of you, making relevant comments and posing valuable questions. Students who are uncomfortable answering cold calls after a few sessions should speak to me directly.

A word or two on **cold calling**. It is often an advantage in business situations to be able to answer a cold call well; the classroom is a good place to develop this skill. My cold calling is not intended to be adversarial for its own sake; rather, it is meant to encourage advance preparation, while also allowing me to monitor the progress of the class. You are always allowed to "pass" on a question if you do not know the answer (though you should only have to do this a limited number of times); you can also ask for the question to be repeated, or for a little extra time. I reiterate: if you are uncomfortable answering cold calls after a few sessions, *please speak to me*.

The PowerPoints for each topic contain several questions. I expect students to read the PowerPoints before the contents presented in the class and try to solve and understand answers to the questions embedded in the problem sets afterwards.

To familiarize myself with your names, each class meeting, I may be calling the names of few students randomly to discuss the questions and share answers with other students in the class. Students who receive two "no shows" during the random calls will lose 5% of participation credit, unless they provide a legitimate excuse for missing the classes that can be documented and verified. Students can earn 5% credit for class participation by actively participating in class discussions, problem solving, discussing on-going current economic issues and else. Solving an assignment in the class, providing the class with a reference to an interesting article or economic debate, or discussing the relevance of a certain economic subject studied in the class to their own work experience are examples of active class participation.

GRADING

<u>Assignments</u>	<u>% of Overall Grade</u>
<i>Class participation</i>	5%
<i>Exam-I</i>	20%
<i>Exam-II</i>	20%
<i>Final Exam</i>	35%
<i>Course project report and presentation</i>	15%
<i>Article review/Problem sets/ video & podcast takeaways</i>	5%
<i>TOTAL</i>	100%

Each individual course requirement receives a numerical score but not a letter grade. The overall numerical score in the course is converted into a letter grade at the end of the semester in accordance with the Marshall School's guidelines. There is no official quota for the number of A's, B's, etc., although the average grade in the required courses can be expected to be close to 3.30 (corresponding to a B) out of 4.00.

The instructor determines what qualifies as an accurate grade on assignment, exam, or other deliverable, and the instructor's evaluation of the performance of each individual student is the final basis for assigning grades for the course.

Each midterm exam is a non-cumulative and will address the subject matter that proceeds it. In contrast, the final exam is cumulative. For all the exams, you are responsible for all the material covered, (including the "application" sections, any material covered during the lectures, the assigned articles and notes, Problem sets, and assigned video segments. You must take an exam only in the section in which you are registered. Taking an exam with the wrong section without prior permission results in an automatic zero for that test. The final exam is cumulative and covers the entire material of the course. The date and time of the final exam follows the University's final exam schedule.

EXAMS

All exams will be closed book and notes. However, a single page containing formulas will be allowed. Your grade will reflect my best judgment of your class performance, as indicated by your performance on the exams and other deliverables. However, I will attempt to follow the school's recommended **mean** GPA target: 3.30 (B+).

Except in extraordinary circumstances, make-up exams will not be allowed. If a student must miss an exam, he/she normally will be given a zero for that exam. If there are extenuating circumstances (generally medical) that prevents a student from taking an exam, he/she should inform the instructor and obtain prior written permission for a make-up. Make-ups will not be given merely for a student's convenience or lack of adequate preparation. Unexcused absences from exams will result in a zero except in the most extreme emergencies. Emergencies arising late in the term may result in a grade if incomplete (IN) in the course. Class work to complete the course should be completed within one calendar year from the date the IN was assigned. The IN mark will be converted to an F grade should the course not be completed. In all these cases, it is the responsibility of the student to document the extenuating circumstances. No student is permitted to take an exam before its normally scheduled time.

TEAM PROJECT

You are required to join with others in a group of five students for group research and presentation on one current macroeconomic issue. The topic of the research maybe selected from the topics discussed in the class, articles in The Economist or Wall Street Journal, or any macroeconomic topic of your own interest. The presentation should be no longer than ten minutes, with a five-minutes discussion led by the group. The project is worth 15% and will be graded based on your knowledge of the subject matter, use of the economic concepts and tools in critically analyzing the subject, suggesting alternatives approaches, and the group's preparation and performance. You are required to meet with your group members no later than the second week of the semester to decide the topic, allocate the workload and organize. You should submit one-page abstract containing the names of the group members, the topic, and the date of the presentation by no later than the third week of the semester. Once the presentation is done, students should submit a set of slides, typed summary of the research with analysis, critics, and references. Some of the suggested topics are: Distribution of income and wealth in the USA and the political economy of the income distribution, poverty in USA, economics of discrimination, inflation and its causes and effects, cross-countries comparison of inflation and unemployment, budget deficit, national debt, trade with other countries and trade deficit, stock markets and the wealth effect, European Union and economic impact on the USA, financial crisis or housing bubble of recent years, emerging nations and impact on US economy, the value of the dollar and trade, devaluations, tariffs and its effect on the economy, economic policies of democrats versus republicans, health care in USA, challenges to social security, and the effect of COVID-19 on financial markets and the economy.

GETTING HELP

Marshall Academic Resources:

The Marshall Office of Undergraduate Advising & Student Affairs offers free Core Review Sessions, along with additional “Cracking the Core” workshops, as a supplement to classroom instruction. Marshall Peer Academic Leaders (PALs) assist students in understanding and clarifying difficult concepts covered in class that week, but core review sessions are effective only if students regularly attend class and actively engage in the process of thinking critically about the course content. Marshall Academic Resources are available for core courses that are traditionally challenging in the business major curriculum. For more information, please visit the Marshall Undergrad Advising and Student Affairs website.

THE IMPORTANCE OF COURSE EVALUATIONS

The student course evaluations are valuable. This course is continuously improved, based on feedback from students and instructor observations.

CLASS ETIQUETTE

This is a large class, and I need your cooperation in ensuring orderly conduct of the lectures.

- **When sending an email, please reference your course number and section-day in the subject line such as “ECON 352- M section: Section: 26367R 12:30pm” followed by your “Last and First name”**

- Please arrive on time and turn your cellular phones off before entering the class. If you are going to be late on a particular day, or leave early on a particular day, for a valid reason, please let me know in advance.
- Videotaping faculty lectures is not permitted, due to copyright considerations
- Private but audible discussions among students are disruptive to others. If you have a question or something to contribute to the class discussion, please share it with all of us.
- You can bring your laptop to the class to take notes from the lectures or work on problems assigned as in-class practice.

COMMUNICATION PROTOCOLS

Consultation with Instructor: If you have questions on course material or other course-related issues, please do not hesitate to contact me by email. Contact information appears on page 1 above.

Economics is an analytical discipline in which concepts build logically on one another. It may be more difficult to recover from failure to keep up with the material in this course than in some others. If you are failing to gain a basic grasp of fundamental course concepts, please contact me so that we can try to resolve these difficulties sooner rather than later.

OTHER PROCEDURES

Add/Drop Process: In compliance with USC and Marshall policies, this class is open enrollment (R-clearance) through the first three weeks of the semester and is closed (switched to D-clearance) at the end of the third week. There is no wait list for this course, and I am not permitted to add students. This procedure minimizes the complexity of the registration process for students by standardizing across classes. If you are absent six or more times prior to the last day to withdraw from the course with a grade of “W”), I may ask you to withdraw from the class. These policies maintain professionalism and ensure a system that is fair to all students. For other useful dates, please see <https://arr.usc.edu/calendar/>.

Technology Policy: I strongly encourage you to turn on your webcam during lectures so that I can get to know you and to better facilitate conversation during class. When you are not speaking, you must keep your microphone on mute. Use of any recorded or distributed material is reserved exclusively for the USC students registered in this class.

Retention of Graded Coursework: Final exams and all other graded work which affected the course grade will be retained for one year after the end of the course *if* the graded work has not been returned to the student (i.e., if I returned a graded exam to you, it is your responsibility to file it).

Emergency Preparedness/Course Continuity: In case of a declared emergency, the *USC Emergency Information* web site (<http://emergency.usc.edu/>) will provide safety and other information, including electronic means by which instructors will conduct class using a combination of USC’s Brightspace learning management system (brightspace.usc.edu), teleconferencing, and other technologies.

Please make sure you can access this course in Brightspace and retrieve the course syllabus and other course materials electronically. You should check Brightspace regularly for announcements and new materials. In the event of an emergency, the ability to access Brightspace will be crucial. USC's Brightspace learning management system and support information is available at brightspace.usc.edu.

Academic Integrity: Students are expected to adhere to standards of academic integrity that govern students registered at USC. The use of books and notes, communications with fellow students during quizzes and exams, or communication of quiz and exam questions to students of other sections defeats the intent of learning these tools. Students also violate USC standards of academic integrity are subject to disciplinary sanctions, including a grade “F” in the course and suspension from Marshall School and USC. Since dishonesty in any form harms the individual, other students, and the university, policies on academic integrity will be strictly enforced.

Academic Accommodations: Any student requesting academic accommodations based on a disability to register with Disability Services and Programs (DSP) each semester. A letter of verification for approved accommodations can be obtained from DSP. Please make sure the letter is delivered to me as early in semester as possible. DSP is located in STU 301 and is open from 8:30 am to 5:00 pm Monday through Friday. The DSP phone is (213) 740-0776.

Registration: There will be no waitlist for the class. The class will remain open during the first three weeks of the semester and if there are seats available, students can add the course using web registration.

STATEMENT OF ACADEMIC CONDUCT AND SUPPORT SYSTEMS

USC seeks to maintain an optimal learning environment. General principles of academic honesty include the concept of respect for the intellectual property of others, the expectation that individual work will be submitted unless otherwise allowed by an instructor, and the obligations both to protect one's own academic work from misuse by others as well as to avoid using another's work as one's own (plagiarism). Plagiarism – presenting someone else's ideas as your own, either verbatim or recast in your own words – is a serious academic offense with serious

consequences. All students are expected to understand and abide by the principles discussed in the *SCampus*, the Student Guidebook (www.usc.edu/scampus or <http://scampus.usc.edu>). A discussion of plagiarism appears in the University Student Conduct Code (Part B, Section 11).

Students will be referred to the Office of Student Judicial Affairs and Community Standards for further review, should there be any suspicion of academic dishonesty. Failure to adhere to the academic conduct standards set forth by these guidelines and our programs will not be tolerated by the USC Marshall community and can lead to dismissal.

Discrimination, sexual assault, and harassment are not tolerated by the university. You are encouraged to report any incidents to the *Office of Equity and Diversity* <http://equity.usc.edu/> or to the *Department of Public Safety* <http://dps.usc.edu/contact/report/>. This is important for the safety of the whole USC community. Another member of the university community – such as a friend, classmate, advisor, or faculty member – can help initiate the report or can initiate the report on behalf of another person. *Relationship and Sexual Violence Prevention and Services* (RSVP)

<https://engemannshc.usc.edu/rsvp/> provides 24/7 confidential support, and the sexual assault resource center webpage <https://sarc.usc.edu/reporting-options/> describes reporting options and other resources

Students with Disabilities:

USC is committed to making reasonable accommodations to assist individuals with disabilities in reaching their academic potential. If you have a disability which may impact your performance, attendance, or grades in this course and require accommodations, you must first register with the Office of Disability Services and Programs (www.usc.edu/disability). DSP provides certification for students with disabilities and helps arrange the relevant accommodations. Any student requesting academic accommodations based on a disability is required to register with Disability Services and Programs (DSP) each semester. A letter of verification for approved accommodations can be obtained from DSP. Please be sure the letter is delivered to me (or to your TA) as early in the semester as possible. DSP is located in GFS (Grace Ford Salvatori Hall) 120 and is open 8:30 a.m.–5:00 p.m., Monday through Friday. The phone number for DSP is (213) 740-0776. Email: ability@usc.edu.

Support Systems:

Student Counseling Services (SCS) - (213) 740-7711 – 24/7 on call

Free and confidential mental health treatment for students, including short-term psychotherapy, group counseling, stress fitness workshops, and crisis intervention. <https://engemannshc.usc.edu/counseling/>

National Suicide Prevention Lifeline - 1-800-273-8255

Provides free and confidential emotional support to people in suicidal crisis or emotional distress 24 hours a day, 7 days a week. <http://www.suicidepreventionlifeline.org>

Relationship & Sexual Violence Prevention Services (RSVP) - (213) 740-4900 - 24/7 on call

Free and confidential therapy services, workshops, and training for situations related to gender-based harm. <https://engemannshc.usc.edu/rsvp/>

Sexual Assault Resource Center

For more information about how to get help or help a survivor, rights, reporting options, and additional resources, visit the website: <http://sarc.usc.edu/>

Office of Equity and Diversity (OED)- (213) 740-5086 | Title IX – (213) 821-8298

<https://equity.usc.edu/>

Works with faculty, staff, visitors, applicants, and students around issues of protected class. Information about how to get help or help someone affected by harassment or discrimination, rights of protected classes, reporting options, and additional resources for students, faculty, staff, visitors, and applicants. The university prohibits discrimination or harassment based on the following protected characteristics: race, color, national origin, ancestry, religion, sex, gender, gender identity, gender expression, sexual orientation, age, physical disability, medical condition, mental disability, marital status, pregnancy, veteran status, genetic information, and any other characteristic which may be specified in applicable laws and governmental regulations. The university also prohibits sexual assault, non-consensual sexual contact, sexual misconduct, intimate partner violence, stalking, malicious dissuasion, retaliation, and violation of interim measures.

Bias Assessment Response and Support

Incidents of bias, hate crimes and microaggressions need to be reported allowing for appropriate investigation and response. <https://studentaffairs.usc.edu/bias-assessment-response-support/>

Student Support & Advocacy – (213) 821-4710

Assists students and families in resolving complex issues adversely affecting their success as a student EX: personal, financial, and academic. <https://studentaffairs.usc.edu/ssa/>

Diversity at USC – <https://diversity.usc.edu/>

Tabs for Events, Programs and Training, Task Force (including representatives for each school), Chronology, Participate, Resources for Students

Emergency Preparations

In case of an emergency, if travel to campus is not feasible, the USC Emergency Information web site (<http://emergency.usc.edu/>) will provide relevant information, such as the electronic means the instructors might use to conduct their lectures through a combination of USC's Brightspace learning management system (brightspace.usc.edu), teleconferencing, and other technologies.

OPEN EXPRESSION AND RESPECT FOR ALL

An important goal of the educational experience at USC Marshall is to be exposed to and discuss diverse, thought-provoking, and sometimes controversial ideas that challenge one's beliefs. In this course we will support the values articulated in the USC Marshall "[Open Expression Statement](https://www.marshall.usc.edu/open-expression-statement)" (<https://www.marshall.usc.edu/open-expression-statement>).

Technology Policy

Students can use AI (e.g., ChatGPT) throughout this class, with the exception of exams. Learning to use AI is an emerging, likely important, skill but keep in mind the following:

- AI tools are permitted to help you brainstorm topics or revise work you have already written.
- If you provide minimum-effort prompts, you will get low-quality results. You will need to refine your prompts to get good outcomes. This will take work.
- Proceed with caution when using AI tools and do not assume the information provided is accurate or trustworthy. If it gives you a number or fact, assume it is incorrect unless you either know the correct answer or can verify its accuracy with another source. You will be responsible for any errors or omissions provided by the tool. It works best for topics you understand.
- AI is a tool, but one that you need to acknowledge using. Please include a paragraph at the end of any assignment that uses AI explaining how (and why) you used AI and indicate/specify the prompts you used to obtain the results and what prompts you used to get the results. Failure to do so is a violation of academic integrity policies.
- Be thoughtful about when AI is useful. Consider its appropriateness for each assignment or circumstance. The use of AI tools requires attribution. You are expected to clearly attribute any material generated by the tool used.

Although it is not always advisable to use AI in this course, if you feel useful for reaching the learning goals, you can use artificial intelligence (AI)-powered programs to help you with assignments. An important goal of the assignments is to learn the material and be ready for the exams. If you use AI to answer assignment questions, I am afraid that you will not be prepared for the exams during which you do not have access to AI. You should also be aware that AI tools may present incorrect information, biased responses, and incomplete analyses. To adhere to our university values, you must cite any AI-generated material (e.g., text, images, etc.) included or referenced in

your work and provide the prompts used to generate the content. Using an AI tool to generate content without proper attribution will be treated as plagiarism and reported to the Office of Academic Integrity.

COURSE OUTLINE: COURSE CALENDAR / READINGS / CLASS SESSIONS

This is our **tentative** schedule. When necessary, changes will be announced on Brightspace.

	Topics	Suggested Textbook and Suggested Articles ABC: Able, Bernanke, and Croushore
<i>Lecture 1</i> TU- Aug 25	Topic-1: Course Description and Overview of the Materials Introduction to Macroeconomics	Overview slides Chapter 1
<i>Lecture 2</i> TH- Aug 27	Topic-2: The Measurement and Structure of the National Economy: The Measurement of Production (GDP), Income, and Expenditure	Topic 2 Slides Chapter 2
<i>Lecture 3</i> TU- Sept 1	Topic-3: Measuring Macroeconomic Data Saving, Inflation, and Interest Rate	Topic 3 Slides Chapter 2
<i>Lecture 4</i> TH- Sept 3	Topic 4: Aggregate Production, Productivity and Labor Market.	Topic 4 Slides Chapter 3
<i>Lecture 5</i> TU- Sept 8	Topic-5: Goods Market Equilibrium Determinants of Desired National Saving Determinants of Desired National Investment	Topic 5 Slides Chapter 4
<i>Lecture 6</i> TH - Sept 10	Topic 5 continued Review: Topic 1 through 5	Chapter 5
<i>Lecture 7</i> TU- Sept 15	Topic 6: Long Run Economic Growth The Sources of Growth and the Solow Model	Topic 6 Slides Chapter 6
<i>Lecture 8</i> TH- Sept 17	Exam-I (<u>Topics 1 through 5</u>)	Video Documentary Due
<i>Lecture 9</i> TU- Sept 22	Topic 7: Drivers of Growth: Endogenous Growth Theory, Technology, R&D, Government Policies and Financial Institutions. Challenges of Economic Growth	Topic 7 Slides Chapter 6
<i>Lecture 10</i> TH- Sept 24	Topic 8: Business Cycles The American Business Cycle: The Historical Record • The Great Depression of 1930s • Negative Supply Shocks, 1973-1975 and 1978-1980 • The Volker Disinflation, 1980-1986 • Positive Supply Shocks, 1995-1999 • Negative Supply and demand Shocks and the 2007-2009 • Negative Supply and demand Shocks and the 2020- Current Economic outlook: US, and Global Economy	Topic 8 Slides Chapter 8

<i>Lecture 11</i> TU- Sept 29	Topic 9: Business Cycles & Aggregate Demand and Supply Model	Topic 9 Slides Chapter 8
<i>Lecture 12</i> TH- Oct 1	Topic 10: Asset Market, Money, and Banking Money and Payment System Monetary Aggregates and Velocity E-Money, Cryptocurrency, and Stablecoin	Topic 10 Slides Chapter 7
<i>Lecture 13</i> TU- Oct 6	Review: Topic 6 through 9	
<i>Lecture 14</i> TH- Oct 8	Topic 11: The structure and activities of central banks focusing primarily on the Federal Reserve System of the United States The Federal Reserve's Balance Sheet	Topic 11 Slides
<i>Lecture 15</i> TU- Oct 13	Exam-II: <u>(Topics 4 through 6)</u>	Problem Set Questions Due
<i>Lecture 16</i> TH- Oct 15	Topic 12: The Federal Reserve System, It's Balance Sheet and Money Supply Process and Multiplier	Topic 12 Slides Chapter 13
<i>Lecture 17</i> TU- Oct 20	Topic 13: The Monetary Policy and the Fed's Choice of Monetary Policy Targets	Topic 13 Slides Chapter 13
<i>Lecture 18</i> TH- Oct 22	Topic 13: The Monetary Policy and Economic Activity in the Dynamic Aggregate Demand and Supply Model	Topic 13 Slides Chapter 13
<i>Lecture 19</i> TU -Oct 27	Topic 14: Fiscal Policy and the Government Budget Deficit and Debt	Topic 14 Slides Chapter 15
<i>Lecture 20</i> TH-Oct 29	Topic 14: Fiscal Policy and the Government Budget and Debt Continued.	Topic 14 Slides Chapter 15
<i>Lecture 21</i> TU- Nov 3	Topic 15: Balance of Payments, Trade, Exchange Rates and International Economic Policy. The Market for Foreign Exchange	Topic 15 Slides Chapter 13
<i>Lecture 22</i> TH- Nov 5	Topic 15: Balance of Payments, Trade, Exchange Rates and International Economic Policy. The Market for Foreign Exchange- continued Team Project Presentation & Discussion Two teams	Topic 15 Slides Chapter 13 Slides/Report Due

<i>Lecture 23</i> TU- Nov 10	Team Project Presentation & Discussion Three teams	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 24</i> TH- Nov 12	Team Project Presentation & Discussion Three Teams	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 25</i> TU- Nov 17	Team Project Presentation & Discussion Three Teams	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 26</i> TH- Nov 19	Team Project Presentation & Discussion Two Teams	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 27</i> TU- Nov 24	Team Project Presentation & Discussion Two Teams <i>Thanksgiving Holiday: Nov 25 through 29</i>	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 28</i> TU- Dec 1	Review Team Project Presentation & Discussion Two Teams	Slides/Report Due
<i>Lecture 29</i> TH- Dec 3	Review One Team <u>FINAL EXAM (Cumulative)</u> Find exam schedule at: https://arr.usc.edu/final-exam-schedule/	

*All details in this schedule are subject to change with adequate notice.

Evaluation Form for Group Project

Please make a copy of this form. Write the course name, the group number, title of the Project, and members' names. Submit it to me before submission of the final project. Please attach references to all the sources that you consulted.

Course # _____

Course Name: _____

Date: _____

Group Number: _____

Title: _____

Names

	Excellent 4 pts.	Very Good 3 pts.	Good 1 pt.	Poor 0 pt.
Introduction gained attention				
Objectives of the research were explained well				
Content was presented clearly				
Content was well organized				
Knowledge of the subject matter				
Economic terminologies and tools were used properly				
Conclusion was consistent with the content				
Data and graphs were used to back the arguments				
Data and information were from qualified sources				
Abstract, slides and report submitted in a timely manner.				
Total				